सत्यमेव जयते

भारत सरकार

नागर विमानन महानिदेशालय

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF CIVIL AVIATION

ANSS Advisory Circular 1 of 2025

21 October 2025

AIR TRAFFIC CONTROL UNIT LOG BOOKS

1. Introduction:

DGCA Civil Aviation Requirements (CAR) Section 9 Series L Part VII on Watch Duty Time Limitations mandates the Air Traffic Services (ATS) provider to ensure that records of Air Traffic Control Officers (ATCOs) regarding the start, duration and end of each duty period are to be maintained.

The log books maintained at ATS units also forms an essential piece of evidence required during a safety investigation. Hence it is mandated that ATS-unit log books at all manned positions in an ATS station (airport) are maintained in a correct and uniform format as elaborated in the circular.

2. Applicability:

This advisory circular is applicable to all ATS stations and personnel of Air Navigation Services Provider, Airports Authority of India engaged in the provision of Air Traffic Services.

3. General Procedures:

3.1 Distribution and maintenance of ATC unit log-books

(a) The ATS- in- charge of an airport should maintain sufficient number of ATC unit log books as per requirements of an ATS station.

(b) ATS in charge should also issue extra unit log books to be kept in custody of the Watch Supervisory Officer (WSO)/ Shift In-charge which may be utilised as and when required at the ATS unit during holidays or urgent requirement (s). Shift In-charge of the shift should issue a new unit log book to an ATC unit *under the following circumstances*:

(i) when the earlier unit log book has been filled up completely.
(ii) on 01 Jan of every year
(iii) when a log book is sealed for investigation purposes.

When any of the existing ATC unit log book is filled completely, a new unit log book should be opened immediately

(c) Each ATC position within an ATC unit where the ATCO carries out the ATS responsibilities either directly by exercising the privileges of the license or indirectly (co-ordination, supervision etc.), should have an ATS unit log book.

(d) For ATS units which are functioning only during specific watch hours, the unit-log book(s) are to be maintained only for such watch hours.

(e) The ATS-in-Charge shall maintain a master list of all the ATS unit log books issued .

3.2 Format of ATC unit log book(s)

(a) The ATC unit log books must be properly bound and all pages serially numbered. The log books are to be s serially numbered in the format *XX/NN/YY* where XX = Name of the ATC position; NN =Serial No; YY= Year. For e.g., first unit log book will bear number *ACC(W)/01/ 25* , second unit log book *ACC(W)/02/ 25* and so on and so forth. *At smaller stations where only one position exists for each ATC unit, the name of the ATC position may be omitted.*

(b) The WSO/ Shift-in-charge should certify the log book on first page as : *"Certified that this log book contains (number) pages numbered serially".*

3.3 Entries in ATC unit log book(s)

(a) Every ATC unit log book shall contain four columns with the first one mentioning the time , the second containing the details of entries, third for the name and signature of the ATCO and fourth column for counter signature of responsible official. At a station which operates a 24 hour watch, the change of date shall occur at 0000 UTC. The date shall be written at the centre of the page in the next blank line below the last entry of the previous date.

(b) ATC unit log book entries shall only be made in blue/black ink. No color ink or pencil entries be made and no overwriting should be resorted to.

(c) No entry shall be erased in the ATS –unit log-book. If alteration to the entry already made becomes absolutely necessary, the previous entry should be struck off by drawing a fine line over it in ink and new entry must be made and duly signed in the log-book by the ATCO modifying the entry. Multiple strikethroughs of the same log-book entry is not to be permitted.

(d) The log book entries should be made in chronological order and, so far as is possible, concurrently with the occurrences and actions. When, during emergencies or busy times, it is not possible to make detailed entries in the log at the time of the occurrence, rough notes should be kept with exact times and *a detailed log entry as a late entry should be made as soon as possible thereafter.*

(e) Under no circumstances, a page/pages shall be torn, defaced, obliterated or removed from the ATS-unit log book.

(f) The log book entries are to be made by the controller on duty;

(g) The time of entries should be recorded in Universal Coordinated Time (UTC) and entries should be in sufficient detail to give readers a complete understanding of all actions taken. Strict attention should be given to the entries on time an incident occurs and the time at which action is initiated;

(h) Every ATCO making the log entry should ensure that all the entries are made within the allotted columns of the ATC –unit log books.

(i) At Air Traffic Control units, where supervisory positions are established (Tower Supervisor, Approach Supervisor, WSO etc..), separate log-books for each supervisory position should be maintained. The log entries of such supervisory log-books apart from the hand-over and taken-over timings should contain the compilation of all important log entries of all log-books for which the supervisor is responsible. For example: A tower supervisor log book at a major ATS station should contain significant entries of all Aerodrome Control Tower units such as clearance delivery, surface movement control and tower controller positions.

(j) Other duties performed by the ATCO such as On the Job Training Instructor imparting training or as On the Job trainee, conduct of Proficiency Check, skill assessment board/pre rating board should also be recorded.

(k) All time periods during watch hours, must be covered by ATCO having taken over watch in the log book. No ATCO should take over two active units at the same time unless units are treated as combined and considered as one.

(l) The type of information recorded in the ATS log book shall be but not limited to:
(i) incidents, accidents, non-compliance with regulations or air traffic control centre(ATC) clearances, regardless of whether an additional, separate report is required;
(ii) essential aerodrome information;
(iii)a change in status of navigation facilities, services and procedures;
(iv)Changes in runway-of-operation.
(v) Low Visibility Procedure (LVP) operations.

(n) Log-entries such as "inform all concerned " do not convey relevant information and such entries should be avoided in ATC-unit logbooks . Specific details of the name of the agencies /persons to whom the information was passed on, must be recorded in sequence as and when required. The ATCO should always make log entries in a clear and concise manner so that all pertinent information are recorded.

(o) The ATS-in-Charge or ATS official for whom the responsibility is delegated for counter-signature(s) shall be responsible for deviation/ non-conformance of ATC- unit log-book entries.

3.4 Handover-Takeover procedure in ATC unit log book

(a) All ATCOs shall ensure that the necessary briefing has been received and the monitoring of the prevailing traffic scenario accomplished before logging-in the "Time -in -position". The relieving ATCO shall use all possible means, to acquire the required situational awareness and information that is commensurate with the effective and safe discharge of the duties and responsibilities associated with the operational positions.

(b) The ATCO to be relieved shall brief the entire traffic scenario to the relieving controller. The relieving ATCO shall first "takeover watch" in the logbook and sign to that effect followed by the 'handing over watch' by the relieved ATCO'.

(c) All ATCOs before taking over watch must familiarize themselves with :
(i) Current weather report and forecast (METAR)
(ii) Serviceability status of all communication facilities such as VHF channels, intercoms etc..
(iii) Status of special user airspaces and special exercises if any
(iv) Current NOTAMs ,bulletins and AUP/UUP
(v) Status of serviceability of radio-nav aids/landing aids,visual aids etc...
(vi) Status of crash and fire alarm siren and bell

(vii)Details of aircraft parking and other information about aerodrome infrastructure(taxiways, runway ,apron, lighting etc.)

Any unserviceability of the above facilities shall be recorded in the ATC unit log book.

(d) ATCOs shall write and sign above their name in legible way after Handover(HOW)/Takeover(TOW)

4. Correctness of entries in ATC unit log book(s)

(a) Every ATCO taking over respective ATS positions shall promptly sign against each entry made in the ATC-unit logbook during which he had been in the position prior to leaving the position. The ATCO will be responsible for the correctness of his/her entries made in the unit log-books.

(b) The ATS in Charge/ designated official shall countersign the unit logbooks of all ATC units regularly. However in large ATS stations where it is required to maintain more than ten ATC Unit log books, the ATS in Charge may delegate the responsibility of counter signature and verification of ATC log books to suitable number of senior ATCOs who should be responsible for not more than ten log books. In such large ATS stations where responsibility of countersigning the ATC unit log book is delegated, a local directive shall be issued including the details of their alternate link ATCOs, who are authorized to countersign the log books in their absence

5. Retention schedule and access to ATC unit log book(s)

The ATCO unit log book(s) shall be preserved for a period of not less than time specified in the table below after the date of the last entry therein. The unit log book should be produced for DGCA inspections during this retention period.

S.No	LOG Book	Retention period
1	ATS Unit Log Book	2 years
2	Aircraft movement in log book form or automation system maintained in Aerodrome Control Tower	2 years
3	Runway inspection log book maintained in Aerodrome Control Tower	2 years

The data on log-books are safety critical entries and shall not be shared as part of information and confidentiality shall be maintained. Only authorized ATCOs and DGCA officials shall have access to ATS unit log-books.

6. Responsibility

The ATS-in-Charge of the aerodrome shall be responsible for the upkeep and maintenance of all ATS unit log books.

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